

## Delivering the Impossible

Software is consuming nearly every aspect of our lives - from dating and finance to delivering food. There's never been a more important time to get better at delivering software. To stay competitive, to survive, we need our software projects to succeed. But far too often, projects that should have succeeded fail. They fail because we can't see what is going on in them. They fail because we are seeing them in the wrong way.

The message of this book is that we need to adopt the right point of view. Seeing things from the right point of view will make us smarter. It will allow us to successfully deliver projects, even when they seem impossible. Part 1 discusses seven ways of seeing software development projects that can make us smarter. Part 2 talks about unhelpful ways of seeing, if we aren't careful they can make us dumb.

The conclusion draws a map. It shows how we can pull ourselves away from unhelpful default thinking. It shows the ways of seeing that can help us move our projects in small, definite steps, in the right direction — towards success and delivering value for users and owners.



**Mark Stringer** has worked in the software development industry for 30 years. He's been a programmer, applications researcher and, for the last 15 years, a project manager. He's worked with organizations such as IBM, Xerox and Cambridge University.

Mark wrote this book because of a realization — he seemed to be repeatedly reading the same book about project management. The same book, but with different titles. This book claimed that, if only you followed some prescribed methodology, everything would be lovely. His experience was, no matter what methodology you used, things often weren't lovely.

In recent years, as well as writing this book, he has written and performed the one-man shows "Delivering the Impossible," and "The Biscuit Tin and the Biscuit," at the Brighton and Edinburgh Fringe Festivals. These are possibly the only fringe shows about project management — ever! He has an honors degree in philosophy from the University of St. Andrews, Scotland.

ISBN 979-8-8688-2204-9



User Level  
Intermediate

Shelve in  
Project Management

Stringer

## Delivering the Impossible



# Delivering the Impossible

Successful Ways of Seeing  
Software Project Management

Mark Stringer

apress®

apress®